

Tariff Policy and Cross-Border Trade

One-Page Research Brief

Question. Did a tariff-policy event affect Chinese provincial exports to the United States relative to less-exposed destination markets during November 2024-April 2025? **Data and unit.** The analysis uses a province-destination country-month panel. The committed sample data are synthetic and show the expected structure; real coursework data should be documented but not uploaded if redistribution is restricted. **Method.** The main specification is a fixed-effects difference-in-differences model. The outcome is log export value. The treatment indicator marks exports to the policy-exposed destination group, and the post indicator marks months after the policy event. Controls include exchange rate, province GDP growth, and inflation where available. **Identification logic.** The estimate compares changes in policy-exposed trade flows with changes in less-exposed flows before and after the event. The core assumption is conditional parallel trends: in the absence of the policy event, treated and comparison flows would have followed similar paths after fixed effects and controls. **Diagnostics.** The package generates a descriptive table, a parallel-trend figure, a baseline DID table, an event-study figure, and a placebo/robustness table. These outputs are designed to make identification risks visible rather than hide them. **Interpretation.** The project is best read as evidence of applied-economics preparation. It demonstrates panel construction, treatment definition, fixed effects, robustness thinking, and reproducible workflow design. Because the project is based on coursework and a short time window, results should be described cautiously and not presented as definitive policy evaluation. **Portfolio contribution.** This project shows movement from descriptive data work toward empirical economic reasoning: defining a policy question, building the data unit, estimating the model, testing assumptions, and documenting limitations.